# Automated Google Reviews Reporting System

Business Proposal — Prepared for Inspired Cannabis

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## 1. Your Goal

You operate **44 cannabis retail locations** across **5 brands** (Inspired Cannabis, Imagine Cannabis, Dutch Love, Cannabis Supply Co., and Muse Cannabis) in British Columbia, Ontario, Saskatchewan, and Alberta.

Currently, your team spends approximately **1 hour each month** manually compiling online review data from WhiteSpark into a Google Sheets report. This manual process:

- Is time-consuming and repetitive
- Is prone to human error (miscounting, wrong cells, missed stores)
- Only produces a **monthly** snapshot — no weekly visibility
- Cannot scale as you add new locations

**Your goal is to fully automate this process** so that review data is collected, computed, and populated into your existing report template — automatically, accurately, and on schedule — with zero manual effort.

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## 2. What You Get With This System

### Immediate Deliverables

| DELIVERABLE | DESCRIPTION |
|---|---|
| **Automated monthly report** | Your existing "Online Reviews" spreadsheet is populated automatically on the 1st of each month — same format, same layout, zero effort |
| **Automated weekly report** | A new weekly cadence (every Monday) gives your team real-time visibility into review trends |
| **"All Reviews" tab** | A new tab in your spreadsheet listing every individual review across all 44 stores — browsable, sortable, and searchable |
| **"Needs Attention" tab** | A new tab showing only 1★ and 2★ reviews — so your team can respond to negative feedback immediately without screening through hundreds of reviews |
| **Complete review history** | All historical reviews are captured and stored — enabling year-over-year comparisons and trend analysis |

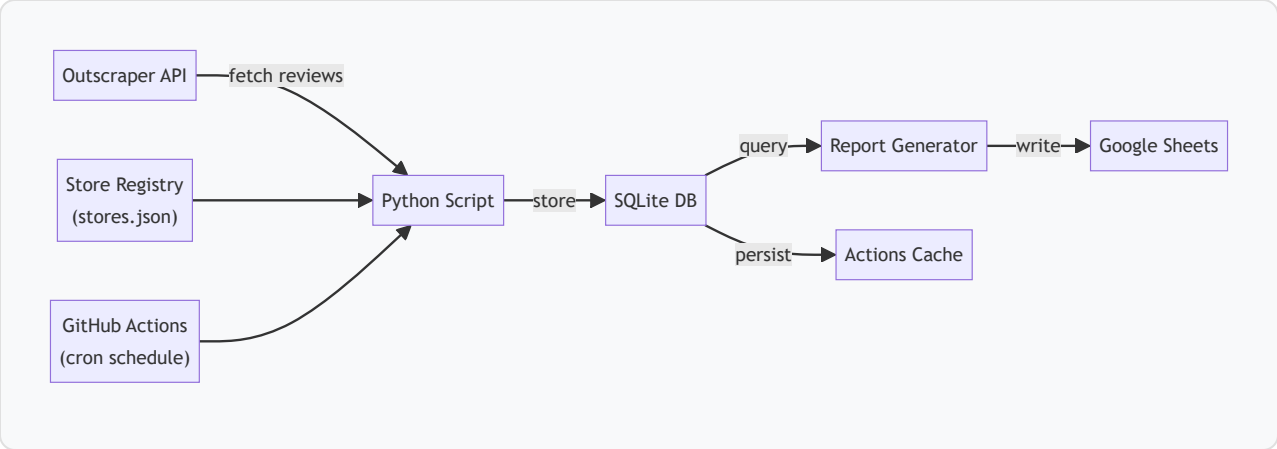
### Ongoing Monthly Value

Every month, the system automatically:

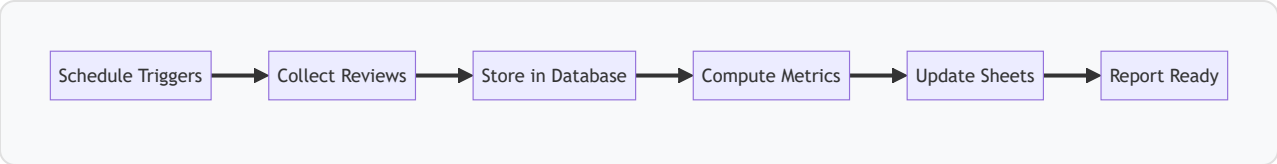
1. **Collects** all new reviews posted since the last run
2. **Computes** your key metrics:
   - Current store rating
   - YTD average rating and review count
   - Monthly review count and average
   - 5-star review count and percentage
   - 1-star review count and percentage
   - Month-over-month score shift
   - Percentage of stores above 4.5 rating
3. **Updates** your Google Sheet with the latest numbers
4. **Refreshes** the All Reviews and Needs Attention tabs with new entries

**You do nothing.** The data is there when you need it.

## 3. How It Works — System Architecture




### Step-by-Step Process




1. **Schedule triggers** — On the 1st of each month (and every Monday for weekly), the system runs automatically via GitHub Actions — no human intervention required.
2. **Review collection** — The system contacts a professional review extraction service (Outscraper) using each store's unique Google Maps Place ID. It fetches only **new reviews** since the last run, keeping costs at zero.
3. **Database storage** — Every review is stored permanently in a secure database. This ensures no data is ever lost and allows historical analysis at any time.
4. **Metric computation** — The system calculates all your standard KPIs: current ratings, YTD averages, monthly review counts, star distributions, month-over-month shifts, and company-wide benchmarks.
5. **Sheet population** — Computed metrics are written to your existing Google Sheet template, and individual reviews are populated into the new tabs.
6. **Done** — Your report is ready to view. No copy-pasting, no manual counting, no errors.

## 4. Consultant Involvement

### Now (Setup Phase)

| ACTIVITY | TIMELINE |
|---|---|
| System design and architecture | ✅ Complete |
| Build the automated pipeline (data collection, database, report engine) | Day 1-2 |
| Build the Google Sheets integration (cell mapping, formatting) | Day 2-3 |
| Initial historical load + test & validate accuracy | Day 3 |
| Deploy to GitHub Actions and verify automated scheduling | Day 4 |
| **Total setup** | **~4 business days** |

### After Handoff

| ACTIVITY | FREQUENCY |
|---|---|
| System monitoring | None needed — runs unattended |
| Persistent maintenance | **None required** — infrastructure is managed by GitHub |
| If something breaks | Consultant is available to diagnose and fix |
| New features or store additions | Consultant available on request |

The system is designed for **complete independence** after handoff. No persistent maintenance is required. The consultant retains access to the code repository, so if anything ever fails or needs adjustment, they can step in and resolve it — but there is no ongoing maintenance obligation or cost.

## 5. What You Get Right Away

Upon completion of the setup phase, you will have:

1. ✅ **Full historical review database** — every review ever posted on all 44 stores, captured and stored
2. ✅ **First automated monthly report** — generated and populated into your existing Google Sheet
3. ✅ **First weekly report** — populated automatically
4. ✅ **"All Reviews" tab** — browsable log of all reviews across the company
5. ✅ **"Needs Attention" tab** — immediate visibility into negative reviews requiring response
6. ✅ **Automated scheduling** — monthly (1st) and weekly (Monday) reports will generate going forward with no action required

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## 6. What You Will Receive Monthly

Each month, automatically and without any manual effort:

| DELIVERABLE | DETAILS |
|---|---|
| **Updated "Online Reviews" tab** | All metric cells refreshed with the latest data — current ratings, YTD averages, monthly breakdowns, star distributions, MoM shifts |
| **Refreshed "All Reviews" tab** | All new reviews from the past month added to the log |
| **Refreshed "Needs Attention" tab** | Newly posted 1★–2★ reviews flagged for your team's response |

Additionally, every **Monday** you will receive:

- Weekly review counts and averages per store
- Week-over-week trend visibility
- Any new negative reviews flagged immediately

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## 7. What We Need From You After Handoff

Once the system is handed off to you, you'll need to maintain **3 items** — all of which are set up once and then left alone:

| ITEM | WHAT IT IS | EFFORT |
|---|---|---|
| **Outscraper API Key** | Your account with the review data provider. Free tier covers ongoing usage ($0/month). The consultant can set this up for you. | One-time setup |
| **Google Cloud Service Account** | A "robot account" that has permission to write to your Google Sheet. The consultant sets this up; you just leave it active. | One-time setup |

> The code repository and automation infrastructure are **owned and managed by the consultant**. You do not need a GitHub account or any technical access. Your only touchpoint is the Google Sheet — the data simply appears there on schedule.

**If you add new store locations**, contact the consultant to add the new store's name, address, and Google Maps Place ID to the system. It will be included in the next report cycle.

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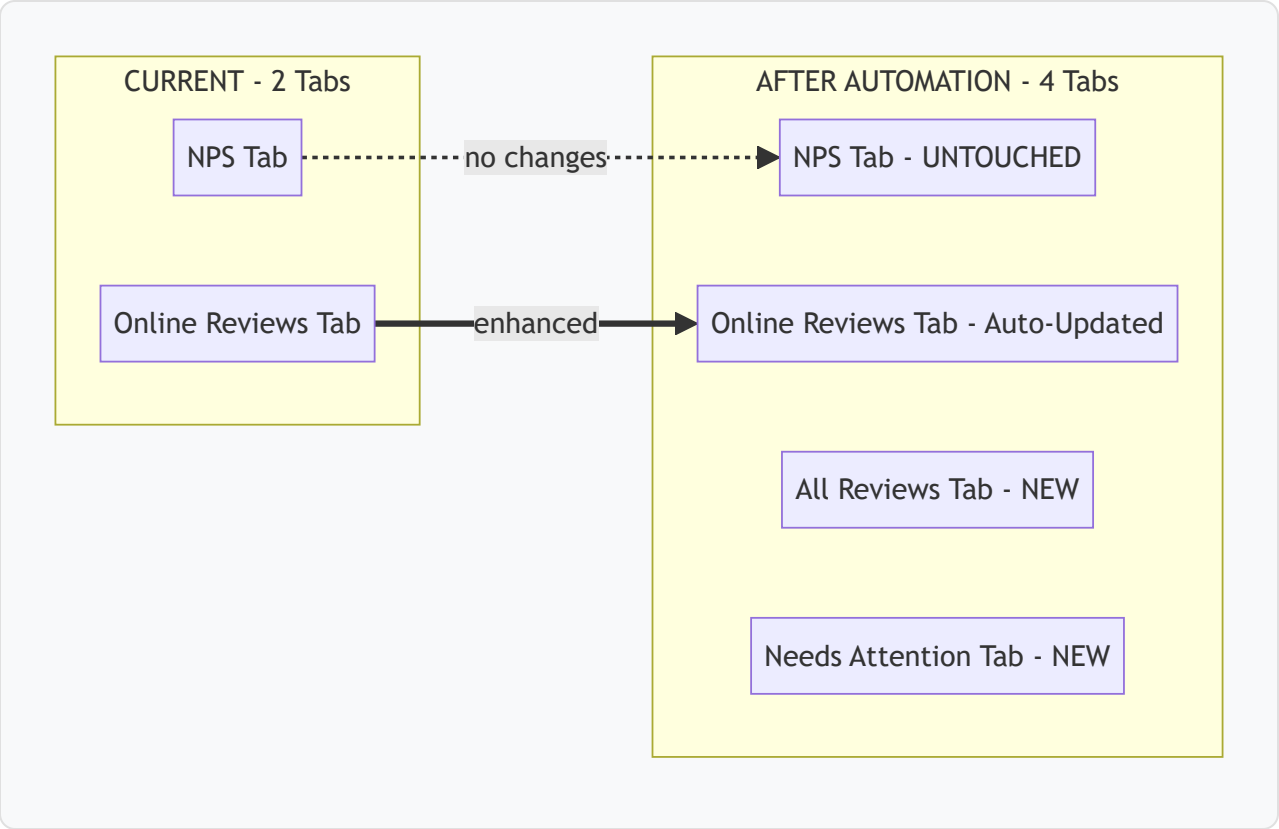
## 8. Changes to Your Existing Google Sheets

**Your current spreadsheet has 2 tabs:**




**Detailed breakdown:**

🔒 **NPS Tab — NO CHANGES**

- This tab is **completely outside the scope** of this automation
- It will **never be read, written to, or modified** in any way
- Your team continues to manage NPS data exactly as before

### ⚡ Online Reviews Tab — SURGICAL UPDATES ONLY

| WHAT CHANGES | WHAT STAYS THE SAME |
|---|---|
| Current rating (Column B) — auto-updated | Layout and formatting — untouched |
| YTD average (Column D) — auto-updated | Brand header rows — untouched |
| YTD # reviews (Column E) — auto-updated | 2025 Average (Column C) — untouched |
| Monthly # reviews & avg (Columns F-AC) — auto-updated | Any manual notes or comments — untouched |
| YTD 1-star & 5-star % and counts (Columns AD-AG) — auto-updated | Row structure and store order — untouched |

> **Key guarantee:** The automation writes ONLY to specific metric cells. If your team adds notes, highlights, or comments anywhere in the sheet, those will never be overwritten. Your existing formatting, formulas, and manual entries remain exactly as they are.

### 🆕 All Reviews Tab — NEW (additive)

A complete log of every review across all 44 stores:

| COLUMN | CONTENT | AUTO/MANUAL |
|---|---|---|
| Date | When the review was posted | Auto |
| Brand | Which brand (Inspired, Imagine, etc.) | Auto |
| Store | Which location | Auto |
| Rating | 1-5 stars | Auto |
| Review Text | The customer's full review | Auto |
| Response Status | ✅ **Responded** or ⚠️ **No Response** — quick-glance indicator | Auto |
| Owner Response | Your team's full reply text as posted on Google Maps | Auto |
| Notes | Free-text column for your team's internal notes (e.g., "Contacted customer", "Refund issued") | ✍️ Manual |

> **Owner responses are pulled automatically** from Google Maps. If your team has replied to a review on Google, the full response text appears in the Owner Response column and the status shows ✅ **Responded**. If no reply exists, the status shows ⚠️ **No Response** so your team knows action is needed.

> The **Notes** column is never touched by the automation. Your team can freely add, edit, or delete notes without fear of them being overwritten.

This tab is **refreshed each run** — review data is always up to date, and your manual notes are always preserved.

### 🚨 Needs Attention Tab — NEW (additive)

A filtered view showing only **1★ and 2★ reviews** for immediate action:

| COLUMN | CONTENT | AUTO/MANUAL |
|---|---|---|
| Date | When posted | Auto |
| Brand | Which brand | Auto |
| Store | Which location | Auto |
| Rating | 1 or 2 stars | Auto |
| Review Text | What the customer wrote | Auto |
| Response Status | ✅ **Responded** or ⚠️ **No Response** | Auto |
| Owner Response | Your team's full reply text | Auto |
| Notes | Internal team notes | ✍️ Manual |

This tab lets your operations team quickly identify and respond to negative feedback without manually screening through every review.

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## 9. Third-Party Tool Costs

| TOOL | ONE-TIME | ONGOING |
|---|---|---|
| **Outscraper** (review data extraction) | ~$15–45 for initial historical load | **$0/month** (free tier: 500 reviews/month covers incremental fetches) |

> Outscraper is the only third-party service with a potential cost. The initial historical load fetches all existing reviews across 44 stores. After that, monthly incremental fetches (only new reviews) stay well within the free tier.

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## 10. Summary

| BEFORE | AFTER |
|---|---|
| ~1 hour/month manual data entry | Zero manual effort |
| Monthly reports only | Monthly + weekly reports |
| No visibility into individual reviews | Full review log, browsable and searchable |
| Negative reviews discovered late | 1-2★ reviews flagged immediately |
| Error-prone manual counting | Automated, accurate computation |
| Dependent on one person doing the work | Runs autonomously, 24/7 |

**The system pays for itself in saved time from the very first month — and it runs at $0/month ongoing cost.**

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*Prepared by [Consultant Name] — [Date]*